Vedha Agent: Installation Guide

Prepared for: Client organisation · **Agent release:** as named by your Vedha contact · **Manager:** `https://api.vedhasec.com` · **Date:** 2026-10-03

This guide explains how to install the Vedha agent in your network. You need about 15 minutes and root access to one Linux host.

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1. What the agent is

The Vedha agent is a small, locked-down Docker container. It runs on one host in your network and checks the systems you have authorised.

It does	It does not
Connect **out** to your Vedha manager over HTTPS (port 443)	Open any inbound port, or accept connections
Scan **only** the addresses in your engagement's scope; the manager and the agent both enforce this	Install anything on the systems it scans
Send scan facts (open ports, service versions, configuration observations)	Collect files, documents, credentials or user data
Run as a non-root user, with a read-only file system and no Linux capabilities	Hold any human password or long-lived API key: its identity is a key pair created on your host

Your Vedha team can pause the agent at any time. It stops receiving work as soon as its access date passes.

2. What you receive, and how

You receive two things through **different channels**, so that interception of one alone is useless.

Item	Channel	Contents
This kit	Email or file share	`vedha-agent-install.sh`, this guide, `SHA256SUMS`
Install token and checksum	Phone, Signal, or your password manager (**not** the same email)	A single-use token starting `vet_`, and the installer checksum below

Installer SHA-256 (your Vedha contact will read it to you separately):

```
<64-character checksum — given to you separately by your Vedha contact>  vedha-agent-install.sh
```

Release signing key ID: **`<ID given by your Vedha contact>`**

The install token works **once** and **expires** (usually after 24 hours). Anyone holding it could add an agent to your engagement until then, so keep it private and use it promptly. If it expires, ask for a new one.

3. Before you start

Host

Requirement	Details
Operating system	Linux, amd64 or arm64: Ubuntu 22.04 or later, Debian 12, RHEL 9 / Rocky 9 / Alma 9, or Amazon Linux 2023
Size	2 vCPU, 4 GB RAM, 20 GB free disk. A small VM is fine
Software	Docker Engine, run by root (install guide), `curl`, and OpenSSL 3 (included in the systems above)
Placement	On the same network segment as the systems to assess, with no client isolation in between. Use a fixed IP or a DHCP reservation
Time	NTP time sync enabled

On older systems such as RHEL 8, Ubuntu 20.04 or Amazon Linux 2, the installer needs the `python3-cryptography` package to check the release signature. Without it, the installer stops.

Network

From	To	Port	Why
Agent host	`api.vedhasec.com`	TCP 443 (HTTPS)	Download the agent; send results. Nothing else outbound is needed
Agent host	Systems in scope	The ports in your scope	The scans themselves

- **Proxy:** if outbound traffic goes through a proxy, allow `CONNECT` to `api.vedhasec.com:443`. If the proxy inspects TLS, exempt this host from inspection (preferred) or have your proxy's CA certificate ready.
- **Security tools:** tell your SOC before the first scan, and allow-list the agent host's IP in IPS, NAC and EDR network policies for the engagement period. Otherwise scans may be blocked half-way through.

Approvals

- A signed scan authorisation (rules of engagement) that lists the scope and time window.
- A change ticket, if your process requires one.

4. Check the kit

In the folder where you saved the kit:

```
sha256sum -c SHA256SUMS
```

Every line must say `OK`. Then compare the `vedha-agent-install.sh` value with the checksum your Vedha contact read to you. **If anything differs, stop and call your Vedha contact.**

You are welcome to read the installer first (`less vedha-agent-install.sh`). It is a plain shell script.

5. Install

Step 1. Copy the kit folder to the agent host.

Step 2. Save the install token to a file that only root can read. This keeps it out of your shell history:

```
sudo install -m 600 /dev/null /root/vedha-token
sudo nano /root/vedha-token        # paste the vet_… token, save
```

Step 3. Run the installer:

```
sudo sh vedha-agent-install.sh --manager https://api.vedhasec.com --token-file /root/vedha-token
```

If you need to	Add
Go through a proxy	`--proxy http://proxy.example.local:3128`
Trust a TLS-inspection CA	`--ca-bundle /path/to/your-ca.pem`
Name the agent	`--name vedha-agent-dc1`

Step 4. Check the output. You should see these lines:

```
Release signature verified (signing key <ID given by your Vedha contact>).
Checksum verified. Loading the agent image ...
OK: agent '<name>' is installed with no PAT or human credential.
```

The signing key ID must be **`<ID given by your Vedha contact>`**. If it is different, or you see "signature does NOT verify", stop and call your Vedha contact. Never work around these checks.

Step 5. Delete the token file. It cannot be used again anyway:

```
sudo rm -f /root/vedha-token
```

Within about a minute, your Vedha contact sees the agent as **connected**.

6. Check it is running

```
sudo docker ps --filter name=vedha-agent      # STATUS should be "Up"
sudo docker logs --tail 30 vedha-agent        # recent activity
```

7. Keep the agent host secure

- Membership of the `docker` group is equivalent to root. Only administrators who need it should have it.
- The agent's identity (its key pair) is stored in the Docker volume `vedha-agent-state`. Do not copy or share this volume.
- Keep the host patched. The agent restarts by itself after a reboot.
- If you believe the host has been compromised, stop the agent (`sudo docker stop vedha-agent`) and tell your Vedha contact. They can revoke it at once.

8. Day to day

Task	How
See logs	`sudo docker logs -f vedha-agent`
Stop / start	`sudo docker stop vedha-agent` / `sudo docker start vedha-agent`
Upgrade	Run a newer `vedha-agent-install.sh` with a new token, using the same command as in section 5. The agent is replaced and **keeps its identity**, so nothing changes in Vedha
Remove	`sudo sh vedha-agent-install.sh --uninstall`
Remove completely (also deletes its identity)	`sudo PROBE_PURGE=true sh vedha-agent-install.sh --uninstall`, then `sudo docker image rm $(sudo docker images -q 'vedha-agent')`

At the end of the engagement, remove the agent completely and tell your Vedha contact, who revokes it on their side.

9. If something goes wrong

Message or symptom	What to do
`the install token was refused`	It has expired, was already used, or was revoked. Ask for a new token
`could not reach …`	Check outbound 443 to `api.vedhasec.com`, DNS, and the proxy (`--proxy`)
`unable to get local issuer certificate`	A TLS-inspecting proxy is in the way. Exempt `api.vedhasec.com`, or use `--ca-bundle`
`this host cannot check the release signature`	Use a supported OS, or install `python3-cryptography`
`signature does NOT verify` / `does not match the release checksum`	**Stop.** Call your Vedha contact. Do not retry with other options
The agent shows a pairing code instead of connecting	Read the code to your Vedha contact, who approves it
Scans stop part-way through	An IPS or firewall is blocking the agent's IP. Allow-list it

When asking for help, send the output of `sudo docker logs --tail 100 vedha-agent`. It contains no passwords or tokens.

10. Your data

- Results go only to `api.vedhasec.com` over TLS, and are visible only to your organisation and your Vedha team.
- The agent sends facts about the systems it scans: addresses, open ports, service names and versions, configuration observations. It does not read file contents or capture traffic.
- When the engagement ends and the agent is removed, nothing of Vedha's remains on your host (after the "remove completely" step).

Vedha contact: your Vedha account contact